

Elementary ELA – Spanish Glossary Bilingual Content Vocabulary Resource · Grades K–5

About this Resource: This bilingual glossary was designed to support elementary multilingual learners accessing grade-level ELA content. Each entry includes an English definition, a contextualized example sentence, and a Spanish translation with definition reducing cognitive load while building academic vocabulary in both languages.

Design decisions were grounded in comprehensible input theory and best practices for vocabulary instruction: definitions are written at an accessible reading level, example sentences use familiar contexts, and Spanish translations mirror the English structure to support cross-linguistic transfer.

Elementary ELA – Spanish Glossary

Content Vocabulary – Spanish

Vocabulary Term	Definition	Example Sentence	Spanish Term	Spanish Definition
Analyze	To examine something in detail in order to understand it better.	We will analyze the story's message in our discussion.	Analizar	Examinar algo en detalle para comprenderlo mejor.
Argument	A statement that tries to convince others to agree.	The article presented a strong argument for protecting wildlife.	Argumento	Una declaración que intenta convencer a otros de estar de acuerdo.
Audience	The people who read or listen to a story.	The audience enjoyed the story told by the storyteller.	Público	Las personas que leen o escuchan una historia.
Claim	A statement or assertion that is open to challenge.	The scientist made a claim about the effects of pollution on fish.	Afirmación	Una declaración o aserción que está abierta a desafío.
Character	A person or animal in a story.	The main character is a brave little rabbit.	Personaje	Una persona o animal en una historia.
Characterization	How a writer shows what a character is like.	The characterization of the hero makes him relatable.	Caracterización	Cómo un escritor muestra cómo es un personaje.

Conclusion	The end of a text that sums up the main points.	The conclusion of the essay reminded us of the importance of kindness.	Conclusión	La parte final de un texto que resume los puntos principales.
Conflict	A struggle between opposing forces in a story.	The conflict in the story happens when the hero faces a dragon.	Conflicto	Una lucha entre fuerzas opuestas en una historia.
Context	The background information surrounding an event or text.	Understanding the context helps us understand the story better.	Contexto	La información de fondo que rodea un evento o texto.
Context Clue	Hints in a text that help you understand a word.	I figured out the meaning of the word using context clues from the sentences.	Pista de contexto	Pistas en un texto que ayudan a entender una palabra.
Contrast	To look for differences between two or more things.	The contrast between the two characters makes the story interesting.	Contrastar	Buscar diferencias entre dos o más cosas.
Data	Information collected for analysis.	The data showed a significant increase in temperature over time.	Datos	Información recopilada para análisis.
Dialogue	A conversation between characters.	The dialogue in the story shows how the friends feel.	Diálogo	Una conversación entre personajes.
Description	A detailed explanation of something.	The description of the sunset made it sound beautiful.	Descripción	Una explicación detallada de algo.

Efficacy	The ability to produce a desired or intended result.	The efficacy of the new fertilizer was tested on various plants.	Eficacia	La capacidad de producir un resultado deseado o intencionado.
Evidence	Information that supports a belief or claim.	The evidence shows that plants need sunlight to grow.	Evidencia	Información que apoya una creencia o afirmación.
Excerpt	A small part taken from a text.	I read an excerpt from the book in class today.	Extracto	Una pequeña parte tomada de un texto.
Explain	To make something clear or easy to understand.	Can you explain how to solve this math problem?	Explicar	Hacer que algo sea claro o fácil de entender.
Fiction	A story that is not true; it is made up.	Fiction stories can take us to magical places.	Ficción	Una historia que no es verdadera; está inventada.
Genre	A category of literature, such as fiction or non-fiction.	I enjoy reading the genre of mystery stories.	Género	Una categoría de literatura, como ficción o no ficción.
Illustrate	To explain something by using pictures or examples.	The author will illustrate the scene with a drawing.	Ilustrar	Explicar algo usando imágenes o ejemplos.
Inform	To give information about a topic.	The teacher will inform us about the upcoming field trip.	Informar	Dar información sobre un tema.

Main Idea	The most important point or concept in a text.	The main idea of the paragraph is that trees help the environment.	Idea principal	El punto o concepto más importante en un texto.
Narrative	A story that tells about real or imagined events.	The narrative describes the adventures of a young girl.	Narrativa	Una historia que cuenta sobre eventos reales o imaginados.
Opinion	A personal belief or judgment.	My opinion is that chocolate ice cream is the best.	Opinión	Una creencia o juicio personal.
Opinion Piece	A text that expresses a personal belief.	She wrote an opinion piece about why everyone should read more books.	Artículo de opinión	Un texto que expresa una creencia personal.
Plot	The sequence of events in a story.	The plot of the story is about a dragon who learns to fly.	Trama	La secuencia de eventos en una historia.
Predict	To make a guess about what will happen next.	I can predict that it will rain tomorrow based on the clouds.	Predecir	Hacer una suposición sobre lo que sucederá a continuación.
Resolution	The part of the story where problems are solved.	The resolution came when the characters found a way to work together.	Resolución	La parte de la historia donde se resuelven los problemas.
Rhyme	Words that sound the same at the end.	In the poem, the last words of each line rhyme beautifully.	Rima	Palabras que suenan igual al final.

Simile	A comparison using "like" or "as."	She swims like a fish in the water.	Símil	Una comparación que usa "como" o "así".
Stanza	A group of lines in a poem.	Each stanza of the poem tells a different part of the story.	Estrofa	Un grupo de líneas en un poema.
Symbol	Something that stands for something else.	The heart is a symbol of love.	Símbolo	Algo que representa otra cosa.
Theme	The central message or lesson of a story.	The theme of bravery is shown throughout the tale.	Tema	El mensaje central o la lección de una historia.